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Molded pulp in India: which segment should Oji start with?

Answer: food and FMCG, narrowly. A pilot tests the price premium.

Electronics and e-commerce
Protective trays and inserts

Food and FMCG
Barrier and leak-proof trays

Auto and industrial
Parts trays and inserts

Jayanth Ram, IIT Hyderabad · Desk research, 19 Oct 2026 · 13 sources

The market evidence is thin and the sources conflict

USD 291M

India molded pulp market, 2025 (S07)

~52%

Food share of that market (S07)

USD 170M

Electronics protective packaging alone (S08)

Food (about USD 151M) plus electronics (USD 170M) exceeds the USD 291M total. Both are vendor reports rated 2 of 5, so I treat them as a range, not a fact.

Demand drivers: ECMS outlay INR 40,000 crore (S02) · auto components INR 7.60 lakh crore (S03) · plastic EPR rules (S04)

Local electronics suppliers exist; food is crowded

Competitor	What the sources show	Segment
Maspack (Hyderabad)	Industrial pulp trays; ISO 9001 and CE listed	Electronics, industrial
Pulp2Pack (Delhi)	Trays and corner guards, electronics cited	Electronics
S M Pulp Packaging	Auto, medical and electronics range	Auto, electronics
Huhtamaki PPL	Fibre trays for food, beverage, personal care	Food and FMCG
Pakka and Neeyog	Compostable serviceware, bagasse containers	Food service
Ecosure Pulpmolding	Made-in-India pulp molding machines	Enabler

Evidence confidence 2 to 3 of 5: company self-descriptions and vendor summaries (S06, S07, S09 to S12). No prices or capacities verified.

Start the pilot with food and FMCG

Weights	Food	Electronics	Auto
Base	3.30	3.20	2.35
Demand-heavy	3.45	3.30	2.40
Feasibility-heavy	3.00	3.10	2.25

Scores out of 5, six weighted criteria. The lead is 0.10 and flips under feasibility-heavy weights.

- Best fit with Oji's leak-proof, compostable, FSC fibre claims and its fibre barrier lid (S01)
- Largest reported demand, though from vendor data (S07)
- Risk: crowded and price-sensitive. If buyers refuse a premium, switch to electronics

Six-month pilot: four hypotheses, INR 8.25 lakh

ID	Test	Success metric	Month
H1	8 to 10 buyer interviews	3 of 8 name an acceptable premium	1-2
H2	Leak, grease and moisture tests	90% or more pass	2-4
H3	Landed cost: import vs local vs incumbents	Cost within the H1 premium	2-4
H4	Pitch trial terms to buyers	1 LOI or paid trial	5-6

Budget is an assumption: INR 8.25 lakh including 10% contingency, excluding Oji staff time. Kill rule: fewer than 2 buyers accept any premium. Thresholds are proposals to agree with Oji.